

BEFORE THE STATE BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR EXAMINERS
STATE OF COLORADO
Case No. 2019-4929

ORDER OF SUMMARY SUSPENSION

TO: Kirsten Gonzalez

The State Board of Licensed Professional Counselor Examiners ("the Board"), having reviewed all available information as to the matters referenced below, **HEREBY FINDS AS FOLLOWS:**

1. Kirsten Gonzales ("Respondent") has been licensed as a professional counselor in the State of Colorado since May 15, 2018. Respondent's credential number is LPC 14615.
2. The Board has jurisdiction over Respondent and the subject matter herein.
3. In July 2019, the Board received a complaint ("Case No. 2019-4929") alleging an inappropriate relationship with a client on the part of Respondent.
4. On September 30, 2019, Respondent was ordered to submit to a mental or physical evaluation to be conducted by or through Peer Assistance Services ("PAS") per Board Order Pursuant to Section 12-245-226(2)(d), C.R.S. ("Board Order"). The Board Order required Respondent to "contact PAS and schedule an appointment for an evaluation within three (3) calendar days of the date of this Order." The Board Order was signed and executed on September 30, 2019.
5. Upon full investigation of the documents and information presented in regard to Case No. 2019-4929, the Board finds as follows: Respondent failed to schedule and/or complete a mental or physical evaluation in violation of section 12-245-226(2)(d).
6. Respondent is deemed to have consented to submit to mental or physical examinations when directed in writing by the Board pursuant to section 12-245-226(2)(d)(II), C.R.S.
7. As of the date of this Order, Respondent has failed to contact PAS to schedule or complete the evaluation ordered by the Board on September 30, 2019.
8. Respondent has not shown good cause for failure to submit to the evaluation.

9. The Board finds that the Respondent has failed to comply with the Order of the Board directing Respondent to submit to a mental or physical examination.

10. The Board hereby summarily suspends Respondent's license to practice as a psychologist pursuant to sections 12-245-226(2)(c)(II)(C), C.R.S.

11. Respondent cannot engage in the practice of professional counseling in the State of Colorado or hold herself out as able to practice professional counseling in the State of Colorado while her license is suspended.

12. Respondent's license to practice professional counseling is summarily suspended until Respondent submits to the required evaluation.

13. Any violation of this Order constitutes a violation of a lawful Board Order and may be grounds for further proceedings pursuant to section 12-245-226, C.R.S. The pendency of any disciplinary action shall not affect the obligation of Respondent to comply with this Order.

14. This Order does not resolve any other cases, complaints, or matters, known or unknown to the Board or Respondent, as of the effective date of this Order.

15. This Order shall be a public record in the custody of the Board.

THEREFORE, pursuant to the above, IT IS HEREBY ORDERED that under section 12-245-226(2)(c)(II)(C), C.R.S., the license of Kirsten Gonzalez to practice professional counseling in the State of Colorado is summarily suspended.

DATED and SIGNED this 4th day of October, 2019.

On behalf of the Colorado State Board of
Licensed Professional Counselors,



Ariana Busby
Program Director